

The Noble, Invincible Bestower of Fearlessness

Ārya-abhayapradāna-nāmāparājita · Toh 708 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་གཞན་གསུམ་ཐུབ་པ་མ་འཛགས་པ་སྟེ

Toh 708 in the Kangyur is a canonical Buddhist scripture known in English as "The Noble, Invincible Bestower of Fearlessness," in Sanskrit as the Ārya-abhayapradāna-nāmāparājita, and in Tibetan as Phakpa zhengyi mitubpa mijikpa jin. It is a dhāraṇī-related or ritual text centered on the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the embodiment of great compassion, and is concerned with the bestowal of fearlessness and the liberation of sentient beings from suffering and bondage. The text opens with an extended series of homages to the Three Jewels and to Avalokiteśvara that establish its devotional and soteriological character. It was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian master Prajñāvarman together with the great editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, and it belongs to the broader class of Mahāyāna scriptures associated with compassion and protective practice found within the Kangyur.

Translated from Sanskrit by the Indian master Prajñāvarman and the great editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé; examined and definitively established.

In the Indian language: Ārya-abhayapradāna-nāmāparājita. In the Tibetan language: The Noble, Invincible Bestower of Fearlessness.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas. Homage to all accomplished ones. Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha. Homage to the bodhisattva great being, noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, possessed of great compassion. Homage to the one who dispels the suffering of all sentient beings. Homage to the one who liberates all sentient beings from their suffering. Homage to the one who severs the bonds of all sentient beings. Homage to the one who bestows fearlessness upon all sentient beings.

Now the heart-essence of the invincible noble Avalokiteśvara, who is free from all fear, shall be proclaimed.

All actions done virtuously
bring freedom from fear of every spirit.
From amṛta, amṛta arises —
this is the one who accomplishes all deeds.

Striking terror into every foe,
in quarrel and in conflict,

when circled by enemies and rivals,
when embroiled in the midst of dispute,
when ever encountering adversaries —
it stupefies and it confounds,
bewilders and dispels all evil,
makes poison and fire confounded,
dispels all plague and every sin,
removes all thieves, and water, and serpents,
clears away all evil dreams,
and repels every malevolent spirit.

It guides to buddhahood and awakening,
reveals the thief for what he is —
this vidyā-mantra is mighty in power,
invincible, the vanquisher of rākṣasas.

When this vidyā-mantra is recited,
from that moment all things stir.
This mantra-king called the Bearer of Fearlessness
is utterly unsurpassed —
spoken by the Protector of the World,
it is venerated by all three worlds.

Then the fearless Avalokiteśvara, having brought the Tathāgatas to mind,
spoke this heart-essence — invincible, proclaimed by all the Tathāgatas:

Oṃ tara tara, tāre tāre, morike, candraprabhe, bhiri bhiri, ciri ciri, sūryakānate,
hemaprabhe, buddhya buddhya, bodhani, sarva-pāpa-praśamani, cara cara,
viṣa-praśamani, ciri ciri, curu curu, sarva-vidyādhara-namaskṛte, dhara dhara,
dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, sarva-tathāgata-bhāṣita, para para, piri piri, puru
puru, prajñāpāramita, anujñāte, ṣaṭpāramitā-paripūre,
gaṅgānadī-vālukopamā, tathāgata-bhāṣita, priyaṃkari, dhanakari, prītikari,
śubhakari, pavitra, maṅgaladhāriṇi, sarva-devatā adhiṣṭhite,
sarva-mahoraga-adhiṣṭhite, sarva-kinnara-adhiṣṭhite,
sarva-yakṣa-rākṣasa-adhiṣṭhite, brahma-bhāṣite, indra-bhāṣite,
caturmahārāja-bhāṣite, candra-sūrya-bhāṣite, oṃ tiri tiri, candrakiraṇe, kili kili,
sarva-śatrūṃ vināśani hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Then the bodhisattva great being, noble Avalokiteśvara the Lord, who is
endowed with loving-kindness, spoke these words to the bodhisattva Bestower

of Fearlessness:

O Bestower of Fearlessness, long ago in a former time, after a number of world-systems had passed equal to the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, one who brings benefit to all sentient beings, whose name was Glorious Invincible Lord of Light. From that one I myself heard these teachings.

From that time forward, he proclaimed it to bodhisattvas and to all sentient beings alike. This essence of the unconquerable, the Bestower of Fearlessness, was spoken by the seven perfectly and fully awakened buddhas: Vipāśyin, Śikhiṇ, Viśvabhū, Krakucchanda, Kanakamuni, Kāśyapa, and Śākyamuni.

This essence of the unconquerable serves to protect oneself, to protect others, and to protect both together. It protects villages, towns, cities, districts, provinces, and royal palaces. It preserves life and grants long life. It causes weapons to turn aside. It pacifies all conflicts, quarrels, battles, and disputes. It repels all enemies. It frees one from every kind of bondage. In every circumstance, it is unconquerable.

śuddhi mukate prabhāsvare śvete paṇḍarāvāsini sarvaduṣṭān jibhayāmi
stambhayāmi mohayāmi oṃ svāhā pavitresvāhā śvete svāhā śveta pata
pavitre svāhā tadyathā tāre tāre tāriṇi rakṣa rakṣa sarva kali kalaha vighraha
vibhata duḥsvapna bhayebhyaḥ svāhā.

Without ever wavering or faltering,
whoever holds this dhāraṇī —
all the hosts of gods, at every moment,
shall guard and protect that one.
No fear shall befall such a person;
constant protection settles gently upon them.
Just as the sun upon the surface of the earth
abides in radiant and resounding glory,
so no executioner, no sorcerer's curse,
no evil spirits can prevail against such a one.
Prosperity and splendor shall come to dwell,
and complexion and lifespan shall increase.

Here ends the noble scripture called The Unconquerable Bestower of Fearlessness.

This text was translated into Tibetan from the Indian original by the Indian paṇḍita Prajñāvarman and the great editor-translator, the venerable Ye shes sde.

Translator's Notes

- The text is a translatory colophon followed by a dhāraṇī text (the Ārya-abhayapradāna-nāmāparājita, the Noble Invincible Bestower of Fearlessness). The mantra syllables in the central dhāraṇī passage are rendered in their reconstructed Sanskrit phonetic form as is standard for dhāraṇī texts; they are not translated, as is the universal practice for such formulae.

The epithets of the buddha named in the final section — "Glorious Invincible Lord of Light" — represent a translation of what in the Tibetan is given as "gzhan gyis mi thub pa'i dbang phyug 'od," a title that combines the text's core theme of invincibility with radiance; no Sanskrit original of this buddha-name is supplied in the Tibetan, so the English rendering is inferential from the Tibetan.

The verse section presents some interpretive challenges: the first two stanzas are unusually compressed, and the referent of "it" shifts between the mantra-practice and the deity; this is characteristic of dhāraṇī sūtras of this genre and does not represent a translation error.

- The names of the seven buddhas appear in Tibetan transliteration of their Sanskrit forms. Vipāśyin renders rnam par gzig, Śikhin renders gtsug tor can, Viśvabhū renders thams cad skyob, Krakucchanda renders khor ba jig, Kanakamuni renders gser thub, Kāśyapa renders od srung, and Śākyamuni appears in its standard form. These identifications follow the canonical list of the seven buddhas of the past.

The dhāraṇī syllables are rendered in Roman transliteration as they appear phonetically in the Tibetan. Some syllables show variant or corrupt transmission and a fully secure Sanskrit reconstruction of every word is not possible.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.